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Theoretical Machine Learning
Learning Formalism and Double Descent

Theoretical and novel analysis, second draft fixture

Waiting for publication 

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Chapter 7. Modelling neural network

We have been

7.1 Multilayer perceptron

Neural architecture, and furthermore of neural network, presents an interesting topic of analysis, in which provide a rather rich experimental opportunity for any given admission. As such, we would like to take on testing neural network in a more complex analysis, but with normalized or simplified case basis, for example, analysing the *semantic* and features of the model evolution. Before that can happen, we would like to cover our convention and model intervention. As seen of [Cybenko \[1989\]](#), [Hornik \[1991\]](#), neural network can theoretically capture and represent a very wide class of functional encoding in closed, finite regime, furthermore with even Turing computability ([Siegelmann and Sontag \[1991\]](#)). Of such, trainable neural architecture like neural network layering, offer NP-complete or $\exists\mathbb{R}$ -complete training complexity, and the perceived power of more depth, layering as seen of [Eldan and Shamir \[2016\]](#), [Telgarsky \[2016\]](#). The question of double descent though, lies in the domain of the problem upon *reaching such approximation goal* instead. This in question, includes computational complexity. If we are to treat that the above presumption on complete training complexity is right, the problem is rather hinging on a dilemma, of which we defer to previous sections on decidability.

Suppose bias-variance applies, and we do not have double descent in question, thus position ourselves in the stead of [Belkin et al. \[2019a\]](#) when they first discovered double descent. However, what we would be doing is task admission-free, and consider a finite setting on approximation. Then, for any measure of arbitrary model complexity $\mathcal{M}(\mathcal{N})$ on network $\mathcal{N}$, results from the neural network construction, we create a set of $\{\mathcal{N}_i\}$ with variational complexity. The task is now to see the behaviours of this, from the viewpoint of structural analysis on different construction of network $\mathcal{N}$, and evolutionary dynamics. Since there are many ways to construct $\mathcal{M}$, what we would be doing is to connect error decision template to different model complexity measure. The level of changing model complexity would be one-level above training regimen and empirical test generalization.

7.2 Experiments

7.2.1 Experimental A - Conditioned MLP

Let us try an experiment on the matter. We fix the structure of the neural architecture to the typical layered neural network per accordance of our analysis on multilayer perceptron. Thus, for a network $\mathcal{N}_{m,\{n\}}$, specify by m layers of n_i , $i < m$ number of per-layer nodes (we implicitly assume homogeneity of layer construction, thus variation difference only matters for layer themselves), the construct $\mathcal{N}$ is single-directed, forward-only in operation, and consider modification post-evaluation on training or

optimization to be *post-operation* of state transformation. That is, the network itself does not evolve, but is externally modified and hence exists no state nor phase transition structure. We can then proceed with cutoff in the same way of polynomial network, but this time much more better. We classify three specific set of components:

1. Input components that feeds the system, we denote such special structure or ambiance context as $n_i^{\rightarrow}$ for ‘in channel’ feed.
2. Structural components of the neuron to be separated into three parts: weighted transceiver T_{kj} of the j neuron unit of layer k , mechanistic interpretation $M_{kj}(T_{kj})$ that contains, in the most plain singular form the activation function, and P_{kj} as the **outer pushout** (i.e. can be said as output) of the neuron component. We admit such modular structure for all components.
3. Ordering of neuronal unit. Here, we fix this to be constructed via **layer order**, such that there exists the acyclic graph from layer L_1 to L_2 up to L_m , not taking into account the input channel. There, there exists no cross-component connection between components of the same layer by acyclic condition, and the order of computation is the same as the directed acyclic graph – all computation are independent of another in-layer, and proceed only afterward when all layer-specific operations are completed. While constraints might matter, typical multilayer perceptron is *fully-connected*, that is, processed information from L_1 is received in entirety of every component in L_2 , and so on. A looser condition suggests the usage of n th order information transceiver. That is, for a node $N_{kj}(T, M, P)$ of neural unit from layer k , then at best connection is guaranteed such that transformation of layer L_{k-j} will be accessible to the of at best n th layer processing connection, assuming the network exists sparse connections. Another condition for the entire network is that all connection must be closed, that is if it starts, it must end of the last layer.

Simply said, we decompose the network out on itself into multiple components. About the transceiver concept, we can formalize such insight as followed of a construction diagnosis.

Definition 7.2.1 (Order- n transceiver). A neural architecture $\mathcal{N}_{m,\{n\}}$ admits an order n transceiver structure, iff for every neuronal unit N_{kj} , there exists a subset of layers

$$\mathcal{A}_{kj} \subset \{L_{k-1}, \dots, L_{k-n}\} \quad (7.1)$$

such that for all $L_\ell \in \mathcal{A}_{kj}$, the output pushouts $P_{\ell,*}$ are admissible inputs to T_{kj} , and no admissible inputs originate from $L_{<k-n}$ to be guaranteed on randomized model initialization, as to mean as determined solely by the architectural connectivity, independent of parameter realization under random initialization. Inversely, for a potentially sparsely configured, layer-based network definition, then the **inverse order n** condition is applied for $\mathcal{N}_{m,\{n\}}$ iff it can guarantee that

$$\mathcal{A}_{kj} \subset \{L_1, \dots, L_n\} \quad (7.2)$$

is admissible to arbitrary layer $L_{>n}$.

The condition at the final end of the neural architecture varies, but usually, approximation requires it to reduce to one. If we are to test multi-to-multi feature mapping, for example, $\mathbb{R}^q \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^l$, this would be helpful, however, the choice of canonical example is such that $l = 1$. Order- n transceiver also pushes another structural preference, that is, equipping traffic restriction such that each component only has g channels count to connect to the next layer aside from closure or beginning input sections of the network. Implicitly, this has justification on a kind of model complexity – the *highest admissible channel count*, and

enumerative total channel available of the network. That said, it does not mean the network can, or should connect all channels. In fact, we might as well in the future devise a connection-aware optimization scheme, though still external, will gauge network wiring configuration altogether, almost in the sense of inverse-dropout, though it can also be said to be dropout if we impose removal condition. The illustration of the network is shown in Figure 7.1. That said, for experiment, we have a few initialization setting that

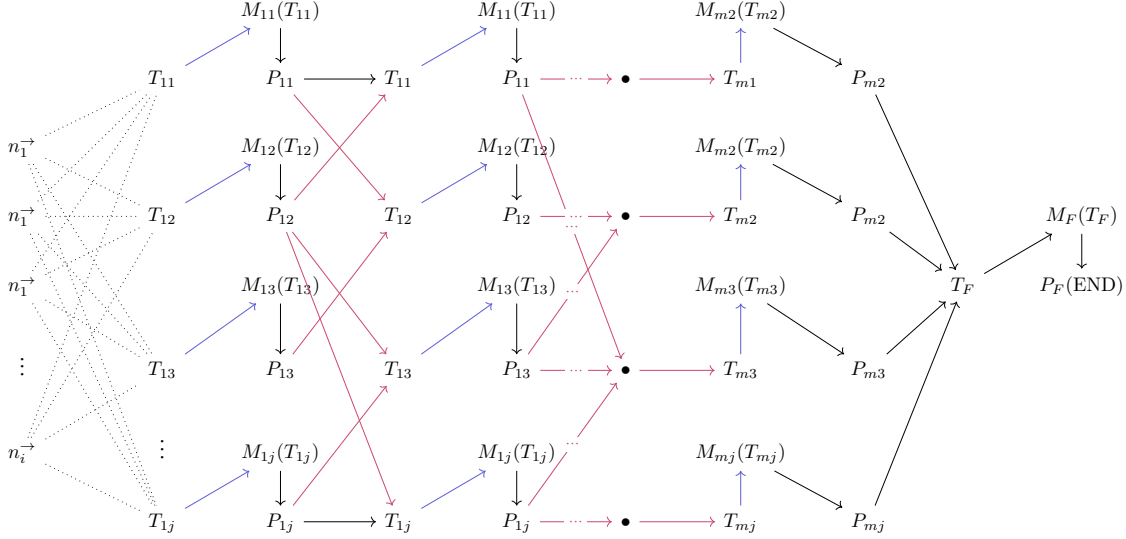


Figure 7.1: **Diagrammatic illustration of the decomposed neural architecture.** In case of non-sparsity, all the graph would have to be fully-connected, and the order of the network is m . The canonical construction on $l = 1$ imposes final compression to (T_F, M_F, P_F) , which is then the admissible form used for evaluation of prediction on based input setting.

can be used. Explicitly, we do not use conjectured structure above of learning behaviours on wiring change, or order complexity. We do it the **old-fashioned way**, but with component-awareness. So, for now, we provide procedure:

Definition 7.2.2 (Standard oracle procedure). Construct an oracle that can be admitted of a form, either in full or best approximation of the decomposed neural architecture (component-based distinguishability). Choose finite oracle context semantic by the size of context per choice n , specify $|\mathbf{X}|_{\mathbb{E}} \in D$ of the domain of interest (if $n = 1$, then $D \subset \mathbb{R}$). Next, **corrupt** the oracle by explicitly setting up $\xi - 1$ -scenarios of removing $\{N_{qh}\}_{i \leq k}$ set of neuron components or equivalent approximated representation of the oracle as the **1st-order corruption**, or corrupting each if not more of (T, M, P) subcomponents, hence $\{(T_{qh}, M_{qh}, P_{qh})\}_{j \leq k}$ for **2nd-order corruption**, and intrinsic noisy interference $\epsilon_{rkj} \sim \mathcal{D}$ for $r = \{1, 2, 3\}$ of the three subcomponents; such can be combined into ϵ_{kj} of the neuron unit for simplicity. Canonical choice for ϵ is $\epsilon_{kj} \sim \mathcal{N}(1, \sigma^2)$. Then, define a Poisson distribution measure $\text{Poisson}(\lambda, k)$. Define a deterministic intensity profile, $\{\lambda_Z \geq 0\}$ of gauging the notion of corruption level in this ledger, thus $\lambda_Z = a - bZ$ for arbitrary $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$. Then, sample of respective ξ -scenario, the amount of data from each configuration you require, using Poisson, for

$$n_i \sim \text{Poisson}_S(\lambda_i), \quad (7.3)$$

from the distribution specified (can be changed, on consideration). After this, we have the total size of the dataset by $N = \sum n_i$. For each of the ξ -category or corruption model, sample the mixture by counts specified above. Finally, add intrinsic 3rd-order noise to complete the set. The dataset now contains $\xi - 1$ scenario on corruption, and 1 on non-corrupted, noise-only scenario. For fully-corrupted set, change to ξ scenario without direct sampling from the oracle.

From this the setting is deliberately simple. We consider constructing the oracle similar to the procedure, then construct a suitable (m, n) -size neural network, first being (1) a family of **multilayer perceptron**, fully-connected with varying shape and size, and then, (2) a family of non-fully connected neural network, or similar functional approximation model type, with different shape and size. Semantic and structural comparison is then available for analysis from the experimenter side. In sparse or near-sparse connection, initialize as normal and impose no g -cap (it is a theorized notion for later expansion on experiment).

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To verify the theorem itself, we test it with a standard setting without the theorem results. This is reflected in Figure 4.5. The result is somewhat consistent with the theorem and its latter parameter error and prediction error results, however, this time, it correlates exactly as the prediction error instead. Additionally, peculiarity occurs in the non-double descent region, with much less volatility than in the prediction of the theorem.

```

Data:  $n, p, d, \sigma, r$ , fixed range  $[a, b]$ ,  $u \in [0, 1]$ 
Result: Threefold error measure - MSE on parameters  $p, d$ , MSE on prediction  $Y', Y$ , and theoretical risks measure by prescription.

begin
  Randomizer( $\cdot$ )  $\leftarrow$  PCG64( $n \leq 100$ );                                Randomizing pseudo-random engine
   $\sigma \leftarrow 0.5, d \leftarrow 150$ ;                                Common presetting for parameters
   $nl \leftarrow \{12, \dots, 280\}$ ;                                Common full-list  $n$  count of datapoints
   $p \leftarrow 150$ ;                                Underparameterization to equal
   $\mathbf{p} \leftarrow \text{range}(1, p)$ ;
   $[a, b] \leftarrow [-100, 100]$ ;
   $w_c \sim \text{PCG64.Uniform}([1, d], 150)$ ;
   $b_c \sim \text{PCG64.Uniform}([1, 10])$ ;
   $w_p \sim \text{PCG64.Uniform}([1, p], p)$ ;
   $b_p \sim \text{PCG64.Uniform}([1, 10])$ ;
   $X \sim \text{PCG64.Uniform}(\text{range} \leftarrow [a, b], \text{size} \leftarrow [n, d])$ ;     $n$  samples of  $d$  dimensions.
   $\text{concept}(\cdot, \cdot, \cdot) \leftarrow (d, w_c, b_c)$ ;
   $Y \leftarrow \text{concept}(X, w_c, b_c)$ ;
   $\sigma_{\text{scaled}} \leftarrow \sigma \cdot \mathbb{E}[|Y|]$ ;
   $Y \leftarrow Y + \text{PCG64} \dots \text{Normal}(\mu \leftarrow 0, \sigma \leftarrow \sigma_{\text{scaled}}, \text{size} \leftarrow |Y|)$ ;    Noisy featuring
  for  $n \in nl$  do
     $w_p^* \leftarrow \text{PCG64.Permutation}(d, p)$ ;
    for  $i \leftarrow 1$  to  $|w_p|$  do
      if  $i \neq w_p^*$  then
         $w_p[i] \leftarrow 0$ , fixed zero point.
      end
    end
    end
     $\text{model}(\cdot, \cdot, \cdot) \leftarrow (d, w_p, b_p)$ ;
     $Y \leftarrow \text{model}(X, w_p, b_p)$ ;
     $\text{approx} \leftarrow \text{LeastSquare}(\text{model}, Y', X, Y)$ , fixed  $w_p$ .
  end
   $\text{MSE}_{\text{param}}(\cdot, \cdot, \cdot) \leftarrow \text{MSE}(Y, \{\text{approx}\}, \text{model})$ ;
   $\text{MSE}_{\text{pred}}(\cdot, \cdot) = \text{MSE}(Y, Y') \hat{R}_{\text{Thm}} = \text{TR}(w_c, \sigma, p, d, n)$ ;
end
return  $\text{MSE}_{\text{param}}, \text{MSE}_{\text{pred}}, \hat{R}_{\text{Thm}}$ 

```

We use the Algorithm 7 for verification, including three modes of error measure, which will then be calculated accordingly. For gradient descent, we refer to another experiment. For such algorithm, we notice that the operational space of the model is $\mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$. The masking of parameters then is not well-received, since the output space is far more skewed – single dimension resultant with no scaling difference

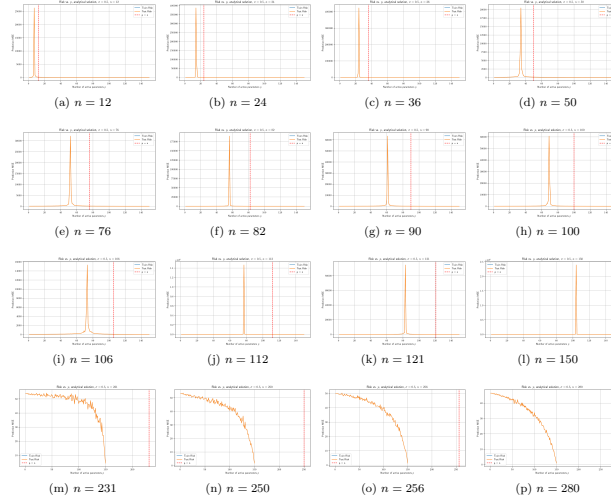


Figure 1: Risk curves for varying sample size n (dimension $d = 100$, noise $\sigma = 0.5$). Double descent is determined in similar sequence, even though the interpolation theoretical $p = n$ is actually shifted over to the right from the actual interpolation observables, in parameterization. Afterward, correlation fails, and the theoretical p is ineffective, similar to previous theorem-based test run. Sample set size range is $n \in \{12, 24, 36, 50, 76, 82, 90, 100, 106, 112, 121, 150, 231, 250, 256, 280\}$. One additional remark is that the error landscape is relatively thin in either side, making it abnormal in comparison to actual bias-variance curvature.

because the model in question is supposed to be linear. Regarding such, it makes sense to realize that the model itself can still attain relatively stable error, because its feature compounds on the scaling parameters

To test the stability of the model, we run for a stable section of the permutations done on p . The result is outlined in 4.5. Interestingly, while the interpolation threshold theorized being $p = n$ does not hold, the pattern of double descent without head descent still fundamentally exists, albeit in a much more constrained region, as can see from $n = 12$ to $n = 150$. The pattern from then onward follows a reduced trend, without the chaotic behaviours seen. The result is shown in Figure 1.

Remark

At least from this experiment, overall, results gathered using Theorem 4.3.1 and variations of it suggests inconsistent results. The supposed interpolation threshold has different interpretation and indication in different scenario, including both parameter-wise error and prediction-only error measure. Furthermore, verification also shows inconsistency with the interpolation threshold, albeit given the fact that the margin of error from the highest peak to the interpolation point is consistent up to certain n . Breakdown of the result from theorem, as well as double descent behaviour starts with high n counts, as well as interesting outlook of bias-variance reappearance for $p \sim 5000$, far more than what is tested in normal testing cases. Such result suggests further experiments to validate the observations, as well as statistical analysis of the entire system.

Specifically, the interpretation of the result is not perfect. Under such setting, then for the concept of the same class, so $d = 150$, any concept of $p > d$ would result in the metric taking zero value of the ‘truncated region’ where d is literally flat on the $d + 1$ onward space. Hence, the error being added on top of such error measure is the component distance of p to the flat sub $p - d$ space itself – which explains the

curve going upward, as more and more risks are configured. Nevertheless, the amount of data provided, at least in terms of this model, does indeed have non-trivial effect on the model itself, and the least square solution of best fit which gives the potential minimal, hence the empirical best. Considering the results, we can see regions where the theorem ‘breaks’ of its bias-variance pattern. Further experiment to verify such claim and reconfiguration is needed. Worryingly, in this particular case, there exists no saddle point that was theorized by bias-variance tradeoff, which must then be explained accordingly. Furthermore, we also notice the troublesome fact that this particular pattern works on *same operational space* models, that is, linear models approximating linear models. This setting is fairly limited, and would not generalize well. However, we also do not know what kind of measure to take in such case. Conflicting notions and reports aid into the confusion of such topic more than can be normally observed, and the anomalous behaviours in some researches (for example, in [Shi et al. \[2024\]](#), we received that in GNN, there exists no trace of double descent) makes it even harder. As such, both the status of bias-variance being false, albeit in a given range only, and double descent in masking certain behaviours of the modelling process, have taken a mysterious stance in the modern machine learning community.

While discovering the double descent phenomena, it also exposes theoretical concepts that are not organized or formalized, portions of the theory and empirical observations that are within conflict of each others, issues with definitions, theorems, and interpretation of them. Those problems would then ultimately hinder further research in such direction, as well as broader theoretical requirement of the theory of machine learning, and specifically to a larger and more complex system of deep learning.

Observing gradient descent decomposition

While the interpretation of what the bias-variance tradeoff, the usual training-versus-test curve, and statistical learning consideration, another interesting aspect to consider (as well for double descent), is how bias-variance decomposition acts on gradient descent and its components. This claim is perhaps reinforced by the work of [Adlam and Pennington \[2020\]](#) which indicates that different bias-variance decompositions effects differently on the total system mechanism.

The main term of a gradient descent algorithm is the gradient of the loss function $\mathcal{L}(h(x), y)$. For the hypothesis h , the number of instances supplied denoted by k has three main cases: $k = 1$ for stochastic descent, $k \in (1, m)$ for batch gradient descent, and $k = m$ for standard gradient descent, for a given space of m samples. The gradient in such case is calculated using the empirical risk on m size, that is:

$$\mathcal{L}_k(h(x), y) = \hat{R}_{S[k]}(h) = \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k \ell(h(x_i), y_i) \quad (20)$$

We use the classical bias-variance tradeoff at first. Since the gradient is a linear operator, we have:

$$\begin{aligned} \nabla_k(\mathcal{L}) &= \nabla_k \left((\mathbb{E}\hat{y}(\mathbf{x}) - \mathbb{E}y(\mathbf{x}))^2 + \mathbb{V}[\hat{y}(\mathbf{x})] + \mathbb{V}[y(\mathbf{x})] \right) \\ &= \nabla_k (\mathbb{E}[\hat{y}(\mathbf{x})] - \mathbb{E}[y(\mathbf{x})])^2 + \nabla_k \mathbb{V}[\hat{y}(\mathbf{x})] + \nabla_k \mathbb{V}[y(\mathbf{x})] \\ &= \nabla_k (\mathbb{E}[\hat{y}(\mathbf{x})] - \mathbb{E}[y(\mathbf{x})])^2 + \nabla_k \mathbb{V}[y(\mathbf{x})] \end{aligned} \quad (21)$$

This effectively decompose the gradient into three parts that influence the overall gradient calculation. Because $\nabla_k \mathbb{V}[y(\mathbf{x})]$ calculates the gradient of irreducible error, which is supposed to be constant of the sample space, it is then equal 0. Suppose a sample $\mathbf{x}_k$ of size km , of partition k . Hence, we have gradient

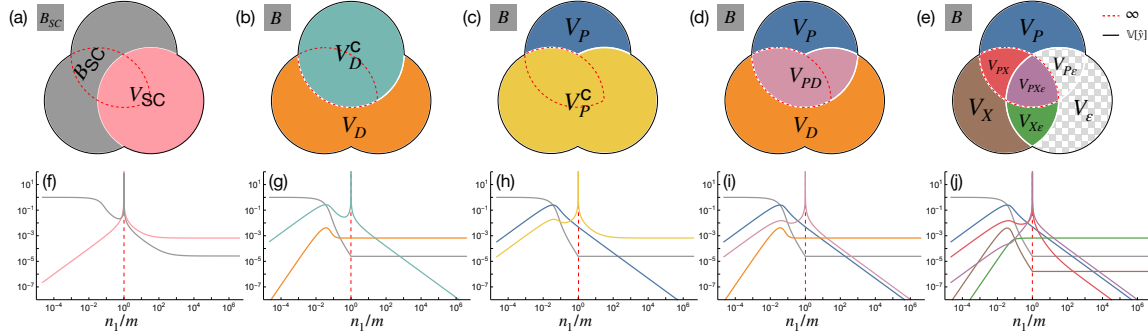


Figure 2: (a-e) **The different bias-variance decompositions.** (f-j) Corresponding theoretical predictions for $\gamma = 0$, $\phi = 1/16$ and $\sigma = \tanh$ with $\text{SNR} = 100$ as the model capacity varies across the interpolation threshold (dashed red). (a,f) The semi-classical decomposition of [Hastie et al. \[2019\]](#), [Mei and Montanari \[2019a\]](#) has a nonmonotonic and divergent bias term, conflicting with standard definitions of the bias. (b,g) The decomposition of [Neal et al. \[2018\]](#) utilizing the law of total variance interprets the diverging term V_D^C as “variance due to optimization”. (c,h) An alternative application of the law of total variance suggests the opposite, *i.e.* the diverging term V_P^C comes from “variance due to sampling”. (d,i) A bivariate symmetric decomposition of the variance resolves this ambiguity and shows that the diverging term is actually V_{PD} , *i.e.* “the variance explained by the parameters and data together beyond what they explain individually.” (e,j) A trivariate symmetric decomposition reveals that the divergence comes from two terms, V_{PX} and $V_{PX\epsilon}$ (outlined in dashed red), and shows that label noise exacerbates but does not cause double descent. Since $V_\epsilon = V_{P\epsilon} = 0$, they are not shown in (j). Taken from [Adlam and Pennington \[2020\]](#)

descent based on k th run over the entire dataset, permuted. Then, the loss function calculates in the form

$$\begin{aligned} \nabla_{k,n}(\mathcal{L}) = & \nabla_{k,n} \left[\frac{1}{n} \sum_{i \leq n} \hat{y}(x_{kn+i}) - \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i \leq n} y(x_{kn+i}) \right]^2 \\ & + \nabla_{k,n} \left[\frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n y(x_i)^2 - \left(\frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n y(x_i) \right)^2 \right] \end{aligned} \quad (22)$$

The indices is now changed to (k, n) for $m/k = n$ as the i th partitioned, ordered run, thereby $kn + i$ runs for the index. If we assume a simplified structure θ_t of parameters $y(x_i)$ depends on, we can reduce it

further.

$$\begin{aligned}
& \nabla_{k,n}(\mathcal{L}) \\
&= 2 \left(\frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \hat{y}(x_{kn+i}) - \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n y(x_{kn+i}) \right) \\
&\quad \times \left(\frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \nabla_k \hat{y}(x_{kn+i}) - \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \nabla_k y(x_{kn+i}) \right) \\
&\quad + \frac{2}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n y(x_i) \nabla_k y(x_i) - \frac{2}{n^2} \left(\sum_{i=1}^n y(x_i) \right) \left(\sum_{i=1}^n \nabla_k y(x_i) \right) \\
&= 2 \left[(\mathbb{E}_n[\hat{Y}] - \mathbb{E}_n[Y]) (\mathbb{E}_n[\hat{G}_k] - \mathbb{E}_n[G_k]) \right. \\
&\quad \left. + \mathbb{E}_n[Y G_k] - \mathbb{E}_n[Y] \mathbb{E}_n[G_k] \right] \\
&= 2 \left[(\mathbb{E}_n[\hat{Y}] - \mathbb{E}_n[Y]) (\mathbb{E}_n[\nabla_k \hat{Y}] - \mathbb{E}_n[\nabla_k Y]) \right. \\
&\quad \left. + \text{Cov}_n(Y, \nabla_k Y) \right] \\
&= 2 (\mathbb{E}_n[\hat{Y}] - \mathbb{E}_n[Y]) (\mathbb{E}_n[\nabla_k \hat{Y}] - \mathbb{E}_n[\nabla_k Y]) \\
&\quad + 2 \text{Cov}_n(Y, \nabla_k Y)
\end{aligned}$$

for the expectation over Z_i , and covariance,

$$\mathbb{E}_n[Z] = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n Z_i, \quad \text{Cov}_n(U, V) = \mathbb{E}_n[UV] - \mathbb{E}_n[U] \mathbb{E}_n[V]. \quad (23)$$

Here, we can see two terms multiplication, for the first one being the correlation between the expected error $\mathbb{E}_n[\hat{Y}] - \mathbb{E}_n[Y]$ and the gradient $\mathbb{E}_n[\nabla_k \hat{Y}] - \mathbb{E}_n[\nabla_k Y]$. This measures the correlation between the expected error, and the gradient measure. The second term is exactly the empirical covariance between the target Y and the true gradient component. Since we are taking a fixed concept case, we can simply disregard the truth gradient hence $\mathbb{E}_n[\nabla_k Y]$, for which the term is reduced to $2 (\mathbb{E}_n[\hat{Y}] - \mathbb{E}_n[Y]) (\mathbb{E}_n[\nabla_k \hat{Y}])$. Under this same assumption applied to the covariance term, we obtain

$$\begin{aligned}
\nabla_{k,n}(\mathcal{L}) &= \frac{2}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n (\hat{Y}_i - Y_i) \partial_k \hat{Y}_i \\
&= 2 \left((\mathbb{E}_n[\hat{Y}] - \mathbb{E}_n[Y]) \mathbb{E}_n[\nabla_k \hat{Y}] \right)
\end{aligned} \quad (24)$$

Looking into some particular algebraic representation, we can write this simply as

$$\nabla_{k,n} \mathcal{L} = 2 \mathbb{E}_n \left[(\hat{Y} - Y) \nabla_k \hat{Y} \right] \quad (25)$$

$$= 2 \left(\underbrace{(\mathbb{E}_n[\hat{Y}] - \mathbb{E}_n[Y])}_{[\mathbb{B}(\hat{Y}, Y)]^{1/2}} \mathbb{E}_n[\nabla_k \hat{Y}] \right) \quad (26)$$

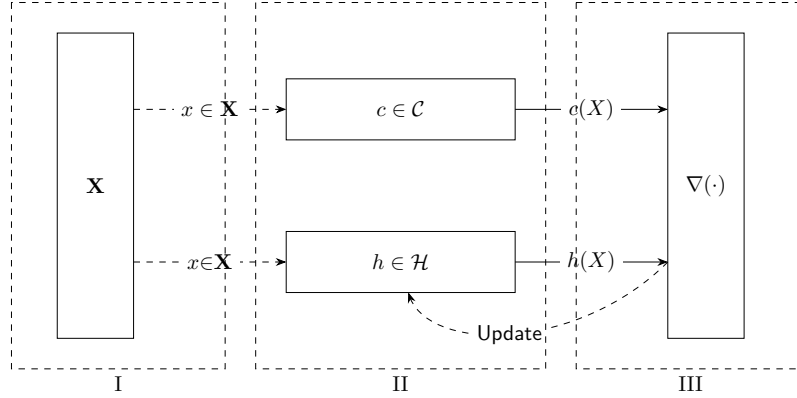


Figure 3: An illustration of the (supervised) statistical process. Phase III contains two parts: First is the evaluation $\nabla(h, c)$ according to the data $\mathcal{D}$, and second is the Update process to re-align c to the actual target.

$$+ \underbrace{\mathbb{E}_n[\hat{Y} \nabla_k \hat{Y}] - \mathbb{E}_n[\hat{Y}] \mathbb{E}_n[\nabla_k \hat{Y}]}_{\text{Cov}_n(\hat{Y}, \nabla_k \hat{Y})} \quad (27)$$

$$- \underbrace{\mathbb{E}_n[Y \nabla_k \hat{Y}] - \mathbb{E}_n[Y] \mathbb{E}_n[\nabla_k \hat{Y}]}_{\text{Cov}_n(Y, \nabla_k \hat{Y})} \quad (28)$$

The first term can be attributed to self-correct of bias-error gradient correlation, while the two covariance term suggests correlation between model randomness and its gradient, and the last one deal with the truth-gradient correlation. What those gradients mean will have to be tested in some preliminary models. Generally, we should not expect the result to be quite effective. Similar decomposition can be conducted for the other decomposition, as suggested, however, the gradient effect is particularly interesting, and will have to be resolved.

Details of supervised learning structure

In a typical machine learning setting, we obtain assume the following figure 3. This includes the ground, input space (the setting of which the observations are observed), the concept $c \in \mathcal{C}$, the hypothesis $h \in \mathcal{H}$, and a supervisor ∇ that ‘correct’ the behaviours of the hypothesis to match with c . This is called a supervised learning setting, in which the learning part is governed by the supervisor and the observations from the concept.

Phase 1.

Begin with the construction and initialization of the feature space $\mathcal{X}^\infty$. By the assumption of a probabilistic process, $\mathcal{X}_m$ or simply $\mathcal{X}$ representing the dataset is assumed to be sampled, or appeared from the distribution $\mathcal{D}(p, \cdot)$ for p an arbitrary probabilistic system.

The *ground space*, or in literature generally called **feature space**, is created. This results in the first component of the tuple D , being $\mathcal{X} \subseteq \mathbb{R}^{m \times k}$, where $|\mathcal{X}| = m$, but $\text{size}(x) = k$, for $x \in \mathcal{X}$. We assume there exists the random variable x of a given distribution $\mathcal{D}$, such that the set $\mathcal{X} \sim \mathcal{D}$ of all observation is given by an underlying distribution. A well-known assumption in this case is that $x \in \mathcal{X}$ has no dependent components. That is, for example, there does not exist any function $\psi_x : \{x_i\} \rightarrow \{x_j\}$, for

$i \neq j$. (Thought, this only helps in Bayesian priori analysis). Furthermore, by specifying that $\mathcal{X}$ belongs to a specific distribution, we argue of the assumption that $x \in \mathcal{X}$ is *independently and identically distributed* (i.i.d.), that is, for a given random sampling interpretation $S \subset \mathcal{X} \sim \mathcal{D}$, all data is sampled with the events space governed by the distribution $\mathcal{D}$ for every instance, and the existence of x_i to x_j for $i \neq j$ is none.

The role of the distribution configuration is important. If $\mathcal{D}$ is uniform, that is, $D \sim \mathcal{U}(a, b)$, then we can disregard the aspect of $\mathcal{X}$ with random variables. For $[a, b]$ to be $(-\infty, +\infty)$, the problem changed to a *regression problem*. If $\mathcal{D}$ is some other distribution function, then the problem of *representative data* and *population size* becomes apparent, which requires statistical analysis to be taken into consideration.

Phase 2.

For the constructed feature space $\mathcal{X}$, let $EX(c, \mathcal{D})$ be a procedure (or *oracle*) acting on $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{X}$ to output $\langle x, c(x) \rangle$. The hypothesis then contains a similar procedure $EX_{\mathcal{H}}(h, \mathcal{D})$, such that to output $\langle x, h(x) \rangle$. We call this the *inference phase*.

The feature space $\mathcal{X}$ is provided to h . We assume c is processed of the same process, resulted in $\mathcal{Y}_c$. Then, $h(\mathcal{X})$ outputs the set of hypothesis' target $\mathcal{Y}_h$. Thereby, we are approximating the *process* c itself. We can approach this in two main ways¹: either *deterministic* or *probabilistic*². We define such as followed. For the constructed feature space $\mathcal{X}$, let $EX(c, \mathcal{D})$ be a procedure (or *oracle*) acting on $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{X}$ to output $\langle x, c(x) \rangle$. The hypothesis then contains a similar procedure $EX_{\mathcal{H}}(h, \mathcal{D})$, such that to output $\langle x, h(x) \rangle$. We call this the *inference phase*.

Definition .0.1 (Deterministic – *discriminative modelling*). A **deterministic model** h_d assumes its internal space as followed. For any $h \in \mathcal{H}_d$ of deterministic model, h is characterized by the mapping $h_d : \mathcal{X} \rightarrow \mathcal{Y}_h$, such that $h \in C^n$ of n -differential space.

Similarly, if the interpretation of the model is *probabilistic*, we have the following definition of probabilistic-based model.

Definition .0.2 (Probabilistic – *generative modelling*). A **probabilistic model** h_p assumes its internal space as followed. For any $h \in \mathcal{H}_p$ of all probabilistic hypothesis, h is characterized by the probability distribution $\Gamma(p_X(X))$, where Γ is the discrete decision process outside the probabilistic interpretation.³

Notice that the process and the learning setting is probabilistic, however, the interpretation of the hypothesis h can be either deterministic or probabilistic, or anything else. This puts the flexibility into the setting of the model, and permits us to consider various representation of the model structure. Furthermore, the hypothesis for the learning process is evaluated relative to the same probabilistic setting, in which the training takes place, and we allow hypotheses that are only approximation of the target concept Sugiyama [2015], Kearns and Vazirani [1994].

The similarity between both of the two general types is that the model is characterized by their **parameters**, both **model-specific parameters** and **hyperparameters**.

¹Note that, in some aspect, this is similar to the usage of mathematical simulation of certain dynamical system, or *any* system that has certain patterns or relations observable.

²The model itself can be entirely deterministic, while the learning process is not. in fact, one of the very first assumption and axiomatic view of the learning problem is that learning occurs in a *probabilistic setting*.

³The discrete decision process Γ is very simple to argue. For example, given a Naive Bayes model with $p(C_k | D[i])$ of the dataset, the probability distribution is regarded as the argument

$$Y^* = \arg \max_{c_k \in C} P_{\theta}(c_k | x) = \arg \max_{c_k \in C} P_{\theta}(x | c_k) \cdot P(c_k)$$

Phase 3.

There exists an evaluator (or *supervisor*) $\nabla(h, c)$ that evaluates specific *loss framework* $\ell\{h(x), c(x)\}$ based on available information, and a *update modifier* $U(\ell, \mathcal{A})$ of certain objective to algorithm $\mathcal{A}$.

In this step of the procedural setting, the *supervisor* includes a loss function, ℓ , which takes discrete arguments, and ‘binarily’ evaluate the discrete result between h and c . This loss function is supposed to have a global minimum, or at least a certain region of minimal approximation. We have the following definition.

Definition .0.3 (Loss function). A loss function is a non-negative function $\ell : \mathcal{Y} \times \mathcal{Y} \rightarrow [0, +\infty)$.

In general, the following is supposed of the loss function:

Conjecture .0.1 (Loss function convexity). For any supervisor ∇ of a learner framework $\mathcal{L}(\mathcal{H}, \mathcal{A})$, the loss function ℓ is assumed to be a *p-converging function*, or as a *convex function*. That is, for $\ell : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, then ℓ is convex on its domain, or is locally convex on $[a, b] \subset \mathbb{R}^n$, if, for $x, y \in \mathbb{R}^n$ of such interval, and for $\lambda \in [0, 1]$, it satisfies

$$f(\lambda x + (1 - \lambda)y) \leq \lambda f(x) + (1 - \lambda)f(y) \quad (29)$$

Under a single structure, that is, for example, a class of mapping $\mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, there can exist many loss functions to be considered. Take for example the setting of regression analysis. Then, ℓ can be either the absolute error, $|h(x) - c(x)|$, or the L^2 norm, $\|h(x), c(x)\|_2$. Different loss function provides different path and landscape, though they still share somewhat similar interpolation patterns, or either some might be subjected to, under the consideration of a loss landscape, local minima than others. Furthermore, the form and representation of loss functions is not discrete – but rather based of its interpretation and the supposition of the underlying notion required for the loss function to operate in. For example, if the setting is *generative*, the loss function would take the form of a *divergence measure* between two probability distribution. Notice however, that the action potential provided by the model in their operation disappears, or rather, is not considered, when using the loss function.

Using such loss function, for the case of no noises or interference uncertainty, if the goal is to minimize the empirical risk on such dataset, then we call this the method of *empirical risk minimization*, or ERM. This is born out of the consideration that in practice, the oracle $EX(c, \mathcal{D})$, and the actual generalization error $R(h)$ is not obtainable.

Appendix D - Bias-variance decomposition derivation in Geman et al. [1992]

Proof. We present the original derivation of bias-variance tradeoff and its analysis from Geman et al. [1992]. Geman’s paper is, by his own word, concerned of *parametric models*, i.e. hypothesis class without strong assumption of parameters defined, though the definition of bias-variance tradeoff afterward and its justification is made in the sense of parametric model. We partially clarify⁴ this with the following definition as customary.

Definition .0.4 (Parameterization). A **parametric model** is one that can be parameterized by a finite number of parameters. In general, for a hypothesis class $\mathcal{H}$ of all parametric hypothesis is then expressed as:

$$\mathcal{H} = \{f(x; \theta) : \theta \in \Theta \subset \mathbb{R}^d\} \quad (30)$$

⁴Generally, there is no definite definition on what would be considered non-parametric. Though, an example might be drawn from the (vanilla) neural network and Gaussian Process Regression (GPR)

where Θ is called the *parameter space*. A **nonparametric model** is one which cannot be parameterized by a fix number of parameters.

Suppose of a training dataset $\mathcal{D}$ of N 2-tuples $(\mathbf{x}_i, y_i)$, that is:

$$\mathcal{D} = \{(\mathbf{x}_1, y_1), \dots, (\mathbf{x}_N, y_N)\} \quad |\mathcal{D}| = N, \mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^d, y \in \mathbb{R} \quad (31)$$

The regression problem is to construct a function $f(\mathbf{x}) \rightarrow y$ based on $\mathcal{D}$, which is denoted $f(\mathbf{x}; \mathcal{D})$ to show this dependency. Then,

$$\begin{aligned} & \mathbb{E}[(y - f(\mathbf{x}; \mathcal{D}))^2 \mid \mathbf{x}, \mathcal{D}] \\ &= \mathbb{E}\left[\left((y - \mathbb{E}[y \mid \mathbf{x}] + (\mathbb{E}[y \mid \mathbf{x}] - f(\mathbf{x}; \mathcal{D})))\right)^2 \mid \mathbf{x}, \mathcal{D}\right] \\ &= \mathbb{E}\left[(y - \mathbb{E}[y \mid \mathbf{x}])^2 \mid \mathbf{x}, \mathcal{D}\right] + \left(\mathbb{E}[y \mid \mathbf{x}] - f(\mathbf{x}; \mathcal{D})\right)^2 \\ &\quad + 2\mathbb{E}[(y - \mathbb{E}[y \mid \mathbf{x}]) \mid \mathbf{x}, \mathcal{D}] \cdot (\mathbb{E}[y \mid \mathbf{x}] - f(\mathbf{x}; \mathcal{D})) \\ &= \mathbb{E}\left[(y - \mathbb{E}[y \mid \mathbf{x}]) \mid \mathbf{x}, \mathcal{D}\right] + (\mathbb{E}[y \mid \mathbf{x}] - f(\mathbf{x}; \mathcal{D}))^2 \\ &\geq \mathbb{E}[(y - \mathbb{E}[y \mid \mathbf{x}])^2 \mid \mathbf{x}, \mathcal{D}] \end{aligned} \quad (32)$$

Hence, we decompose it to:

$$\begin{aligned} & \mathbb{E}[(y - f(\mathbf{x}; \mathcal{D}))^2 \mid \mathbf{x}, \mathcal{D}] \\ &= \mathbb{E}[(y - \mathbb{E}[y \mid \mathbf{x}])^2 \mid \mathbf{x}, \mathcal{D}] + (f(\mathbf{x}; \mathcal{D}) - \mathbb{E}[y \mid \mathbf{x}])^2 \end{aligned} \quad (33)$$

Where $\mathbb{E}[(y - \mathbb{E}[y \mid \mathbf{x}])^2 \mid \mathbf{x}, \mathcal{D}]$ is regarded to be a relative constant of variance on y given $\mathbf{x}$. Taking the expectation on $\mathcal{D}$, we gain:

$$\begin{aligned} & \mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{D}}\left\{\mathbb{E}[(y - f(\mathbf{x}; \mathcal{D}))^2 \mid \mathbf{x}, \mathcal{D}]\right\} \\ &= \mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{D}}\left\{\mathbb{E}[(y - \mathbb{E}[y \mid \mathbf{x}])^2 \mid \mathbf{x}, \mathcal{D}] + (f(\mathbf{x}; \mathcal{D}) - \mathbb{E}[y \mid \mathbf{x}])^2\right\} \\ &= \mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{D}}\left\{\mathbb{E}[(y - \mathbb{E}[y \mid \mathbf{x}])^2 \mid \mathbf{x}, \mathcal{D}]\right\} + \\ &\quad \mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{D}}\left\{(f(\mathbf{x}; \mathcal{D}) - \mathbb{E}[y \mid \mathbf{x}])^2\right\} \end{aligned} \quad (34)$$

The second term is of importance, and is further decomposed to:

$$\begin{aligned}
& \mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{D}} \left\{ (f(\mathbf{x}; \mathcal{D}) - \mathbb{E}[y | \mathbf{x}])^2 \right\} \\
&= \mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{D}} \left\{ (f(\mathbf{x}; \mathcal{D}) - \mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{D}}[f(\mathbf{x}; \mathcal{D})] + \mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{D}}[f(\mathbf{x}; \mathcal{D})] - \mathbb{E}[y | \mathbf{x}])^2 \right\} \\
&= \mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{D}} \left[(f(\mathbf{x}; \mathcal{D}) - \mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{D}}[f(\mathbf{x}; \mathcal{D})])^2 \right] \\
&\quad + \mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{D}} \left[(\mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{D}}[f(\mathbf{x}; \mathcal{D})] - \mathbb{E}[y | \mathbf{x}])^2 \right] \\
&\quad + 2\mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{D}} \left[(f(\mathbf{x}; \mathcal{D}) - \mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{D}}[f(\mathbf{x}; \mathcal{D})]) \cdot (\mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{D}}[f(\mathbf{x}; \mathcal{D})] - \mathbb{E}[y | \mathbf{x}]) \right] \\
&= \underbrace{\{\mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{D}}[f(x; \mathcal{D})] - \mathbb{E}[y | x]\}}_{\text{bias term}} \\
&\quad + \underbrace{\mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{D}} \{ (f(x; \mathcal{D}) - \mathbb{E}_{\mathcal{D}}[f(x; \mathcal{D})])^2 \}}_{\text{variance term}}
\end{aligned} \tag{35}$$

which yields the desired bias-variance tradeoff. $\square$

Practical consideration

While we have been talking in the learning setting pretty loosely on the side of the data itself, it is the data that gives us the problem setting. For example, if the data is a pair (X, Y) of input output representation, then we know that our working space would be $\mathbb{R}^n \times \mathbb{R}^m$ or any of its subset, given the fact that data must be encoded into numerical representations, even in discrete or logical case (in such case, typically, 0 – 1 pair is enough). In more complex and complicated setting, for example, on the structure of a graph and its embedded representation, it is much more difficult to see the *form of dataset* to be, hence, also the working space.

Another thing with data is the *availability of the data* and the *distribution of the data* also matters. In some cases, our data consists of only skewed or partitioned sections of the actual concept range, at least up to the observable criterion of the concept (some concept does not exist in certain range, at least in a numerical example, and some other reasons). In the other case, the availability of data, meaning the density of data, as well as added *observational effect* also alters the learning setting, simply because learning theory relies on, at least from our glance, simple statistical, observational learning from observation space, without the added structures. An actual, practical concern however, lies in the range of **practical empirical-generalization** setting.

Observational space partitioning

Previously, we established that at least in said formal setting, generalization errors cannot be known beforehand. Thereby, all of our operations, procedures, processes has to be conducted using the observed data, or the sample space $\mathcal{S}$. A solution to utilize that is to consider the generalization region as the region of *new, unseen observations* that while still is of the same concept c , but it is indeed, unseen if the model is never provided of such instances. Hence, it prompts the utilization of limited resources by then to partition the sample space into various subspaces, that would be then fed into the learning process as observational space. This is simply called **sample set partitioning**. Denoted the number of partition (discrete) as k , then for $k = 2$, then this is called the **train-test partition** (or dataset). This contains a dataset $\mathbf{x}_1$ and $\mathbf{x}_2$ of the

same original sample set, such that $x_1/x_2 \geq 1$ (one is bigger than another, usually). The ratio does indeed affect the overall running procedure, accordingly⁵.

Based on the above conclusion, the empirical error and generalized error can be re-calculated to fit the general scheme. For $|S| = m$ and partition $k + p = m$ for train and test partition respectively,

$$\hat{R}_k(h) = \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k \ell\{h(x_i), c(x_i)\}, \quad (36)$$

$$\hat{R}_p(h_{\mathcal{A}}) = \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^p \ell\{h_{\mathcal{A}}(x_i), c(x_i)\} \quad (37)$$

where $h_{\mathcal{A}}$ is the result from the learning algorithm (procedure), for $h^* \neq h_{\mathcal{A}}$. Then, the empirical learning seeks to optimize the first term, that is, for the objective

$$\arg \min_{h \in \mathcal{H}} \hat{R}_k(h) = \arg \min_{h \in \mathcal{H}} \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k \ell\{h(x_i), c(x_i)\} \quad (38)$$

and the generalization learning as:

$$\begin{aligned} & \arg \min_{h \in \mathcal{H}} \hat{R}_p(h_{\mathcal{A}}) \\ &= \hat{R}_k(h_{\mathcal{A}}) + \arg \min_{h \in \mathcal{H}} \hat{R}_p(h_{\mathcal{A}}) \\ &= \arg \min_{h \in \mathcal{H}} \left[\frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^k \ell\{h_{\mathcal{A}}(x_i), c(x_i)\} + \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^p \ell\{h_{\mathcal{A}}(x_i), c(x_i)\} \right] \\ &= \arg \min_{h \in \mathcal{H}} \left[\epsilon + \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=1}^p \ell\{h_{\mathcal{A}}(x_i), c(x_i)\} \right] \end{aligned} \quad (39)$$

By the definition order, the generalization error can only be calculated post- $\mathcal{A}$. Hence, we often called the empirical, or ERM-generalizer case to be dynamic, and the solution for ERM is tested statically on generalization set. This partition of order of computation though, brings up the problem of updating factors and others contributing potential that will damage or diffuse the measure.

For cross-validation and other randomize partition, the formulation requires more care in the notion by itself. The structural risk minimization scheme dilemma can be understood from the above consideration naturally. We have effectively defined the two proxies, **heuristic empirical risk** and **heuristic generalization risk**.

⁵If $k > 3$ and above, we call it the n th partitioning. If we further consider the choice of observational spaces being provided, then if $k > 3$, and subspaces are chosen randomly, it is called **cross-validating partition**. The effect of them are fairly well-understood, and we might as well refer to authoritative sources on such issue.

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